Speak out
3RD EDITION

B2+
UNIT 2 TEST | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the words in brackets.

1 She wore a yellow raincoat.
What _____ a yellow raincoat. (wore)
2 They ran a marathon at the weekend.
What _____ a marathon at the weekend. (ran)
3 Kieran hates brushing his hair.
What Kieran _____ his hair. (doing)
4 Marcia helps her mother in the restaurant.
What _____ her mother in the restaurant. (does)
5 Lexi loves her pet spider.
What _____ her pet spider. (loves)
6 My grandparents bought me a suit for my birthday.
What my grandparents _____ me a suit for my birthday. (did)
7 My sister is driving me to the station.
What my sister _____ me to the station. (doing)
8 We teach your employees to work better as a team.
What _____ your employees to work better as a team. (do)
9 She'll show you how to stay in shape.
What _____ you how to stay in shape. (do)
10 He was shouting at the neighbours.
What _____ at the neighbours. (doing)

/10

2 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box.

did	do so	hadn't	has	having	much	not	some	the same	was

1 Henri wasn't at the meeting, but Rita _____.
2 Preet hasn't got a degree, but Cassie _____.
3 He doesn't have any paintings on his walls, but he'd like _____.
4 I've got a bit of cash, but I haven't got _____.
5 We'd already eaten in that café, but they _____.
6 A: I wonder if he'll be late for dinner.
B: I hope _____. I'm starving.
7 They've been spending a lot of time together and _____ a lot of fun.
8 She didn't know his name, but I _____.
9 All of the guests raised their glasses, so I did _____.
10 They said they're going to cancel the show, but I'm sure they won't _____.

/10

VOCABULARY

3 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

conned	disgraceful	faked	get away with
let them win	on top	played fair	their head up

1 It doesn't matter how badly he performs, he always comes out _____.
2 We shouldn't have _____ the match. They were much worse than us.
3 They thought they could _____ cheating and that no one would notice.
4 Even if they didn't win, they played really well so they can hold _____.
5 That man _____ me. He totally cheated and misled me.

/5

4 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 She wasn't tripped up. She clearly **dived** / **jumped** to the floor.
2 Rangers remain **beaten** / **unbeaten** this season, having won or drawn all of their matches.
3 Harmen is the current world champion, so she's the **favourite** / **underdog** to win this race.
4 Don't **bend** / **play** the rules. What you're trying to do isn't fair.
5 He couldn't win the game so he **cheated** / **conceded** to his opponent.

/5

5 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for industry competition.

1 If the two companies form an **a** _ _ _ _ _ _ **e**, they'll be far more successful.
2 We need to work much harder in order to fulfil our **p** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **l**.
3 The firms had been **b** _ _ _ _ **r** rivals for half a century until they agreed to work more closely.
4 We need greater **c** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **n**. We won't achieve our goals without working together.
5 In order to achieve your goals, you'll need to **p** _ _ **h** **b** _ _ _ _ **d** your limits.

/5

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6 Match the sentence beginnings (1–5) with the sentence endings (a–e).

1 I thought Kat took
2 The players were neck and
3 Let's play best
4 There was a lot
5 They played three

a neck for much of the race.
b rounds before they got bored of the game.
c it really well when I told her the news.
d to take in, but I enjoyed the course.
e of three to see who'll win the trophy.

/5

HOW TO …

7 Choose the correct option (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 Our old machine wasted too much electricity so we hope the new one will improve ___.
a cutbacks **b** efficiency **c** initiative
2 The company's ___ has increased by fifty million dollars this year alone.
a bankruptcy **b** productivity **c** turnover
3 Other companies are able to produce goods more cheaply so we have lost some of our ___.
a cutbacks **b** initiative **c** competitiveness
4 This little device is ___ peeling potatoes. It does it quickly and well.
a useful for **b** useless at **c** ineffective for
5 These trainers are ___ as comfortable as my old ones. They really hurt my feet!
a almost **b** nowhere near **c** way more
6 The two candidates are ___ talented so I don't know which one to choose for the job.
a marginally **b** nothing like **c** equally
7 My experience with this company has been ___ me. I'm sure it will help me in future.
a effective in **b** useless for **c** valuable to
8 The camera on this smartphone is ___ better than the one on my old phone.
a infinitely **b** every bit **c** nothing like
9 Lyons' latest novel is ___ powerful as her previous one.
a a little **b** almost as **c** marginally
10 The proposed solution has been ___ dealing with the traffic problem. There are just as many cars on the road.
a ineffective in **b** valuable to **c** invaluable for

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Total: /50

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Part B • Listening, Reading and Writing

LISTENING

1 [Audio UT2.01] Listen to Ed and Jessica talking about winning at all costs. Number the topics (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A Ambitious goals can have a negative effect on different people. ___
B Success in sports has become a priority for some people. ___
C Valorie Kondos Field's recommendations for training people. ___
D A disappointing experience which Jessica has had recently. ___
E The way coach Valorie Kondos Field used to train gymnasts. ___

/5

2 [Audio UT2.01] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Jessica thinks the behaviour of her opponents in a hockey match was unacceptable. **T** / **F**
2 Jessica's team had been drawing with their rivals for part of the hockey match. **T** / **F**
3 Jessica thinks an opponent was pushed to the floor by accident. **T** / **F**
4 Ed doesn't think people take sports seriously enough. **T** / **F**
5 Jessica talks about why some people will do anything to win a sports event. **T** / **F**
6 Jessica describes a gymnast who was only happy when she won a competition. **T** / **F**
7 Ed thinks it is unusual for people to do more than they are capable of in their jobs. **T** / **F**
8 Jessica thinks the problem of winning at all costs is limited to sports. **T** / **F**
9 Jessica explains why the presenter needed to change her coaching technique. **T** / **F**
10 Ed agrees that a whole-person approach to coaching could be useful in different contexts. **T** / **F**

/10

READING

3 Read an interview with the manager of a retail cooperative. Match the interview questions (A–E) with the paragraphs (1–5).

A You mentioned earlier that your members know bicycles inside and out. What do you mean by that?
B The Bicycle Cooperative is different from a workers' cooperative. What are the main differences?
C The cooperative sounds good for bike-shop owners, but are there any benefits for society in general?
D The cooperative represents more than two hundred bicycle shops. How did it come about?
E What other advantages are there for members of the cooperative?

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The Bicycle Cooperative

Saul Bryant interviews Tania Stevenson about how cooperation has helped the UK's independent bicycle shops.

1 ___
We're a retail cooperative, which means our members own independent bicycle shops across the country. In a workers' cooperative, a company's employees are members of the cooperative, so they have a say in the running of the company. They can decide their own conditions of employment, choose the directors, and set company policies. While some of our members are workers' cooperatives, they don't have to be. Instead, our role is to give more power to bike-shop owners who might otherwise struggle to compete with bigger companies. Our members are retailers who know bicycles inside and out, and our mission is to help them fulfil their potential in a very competitive market.

2 ___
The story started in the 1980s with two bike-shop owners from the southwest of England. They both had long-established bicycle shops in the same city, but when a large bicycle superstore opened, they both found it hard to compete. Although they could offer a better service, they couldn't match the superstore's prices. Finding themselves on the edge of bankruptcy, they decided to form an alliance. They found that by working together, they could negotiate better prices from manufacturers and share their knowledge of the local market. At that point, it was just a simple collaboration in order to help their shops survive. However, when other shop owners were invited to join them, the cooperative became a much more professional organisation.

3 ___
They're experts in recommending the most suitable bikes to their customers and helping to maintain them. They're far more knowledgeable than the average salesperson in a bicycle superstore and they offer a service you don't get if you buy a bike online. They know which bikes are the best value for money and which parts are the most reliable. One of the advantages of joining our cooperative is that independent retailers can also share that knowledge with each other. There are regular online workshops given by our members on topics like bike maintenance and our annual conference brings members together to discuss the latest developments in bicycle technology.

4 ___
One of the main benefits, which I've already mentioned, is that we can negotiate better prices for bicycles and parts from wholesalers. Traditionally, this is what has given the competitive edge to the bigger retailers. However, the sheer size of our cooperative means our members have a better chance of competing with them. Similarly, we offer a range of business services, which help our members improve their efficiency. One example is marketing. It's so essential to the success of a business, but it can be costly, so shop owners try to manage it themselves. Yet, due to a lack of expertise, their marketing campaigns are frequently ineffective. The cooperative has solved this problem by having a professional marketing department, which does the work for them. We've carried out many successful campaigns which have led to increased sales for our members.

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5 ___
The most important thing we do is help local businesses be profitable and competitive. Over the last few decades, towns and cities have seen local shops closing down at a rapid rate. However, we believe they have a key role to play in the local economy because they create jobs and income for local people. Not only that, but they draw customers into the area, which helps other businesses. Apart from that, we have forged partnerships with several not-for-profit cycling organisations involved in improving health and the environment. Many of our members are passionate about both of those things, and, through our network of stores, we've helped these organisations raise awareness of events and campaigns to get people onto bikes.

4 Read the interview again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 How are the members of a retail cooperative different from a workers' cooperative?
A They all have problems competing with big companies.
B They all have little potential in a competitive market.
C They are all responsible for businesses of their own.
D They are all employed by business owners.

2 Why did the original members decide to work together?
A They didn't want to compete against each other.
B They had little previous experience of running a shop.
C They lacked the skills and knowledge to work alone.
D They were both facing severe financial difficulties.

3 What is the advantage of buying a bicycle from one of the cooperative's members?
A Their prices are more competitive than the larger stores.
B Their staff are more effective in making recommendations.
C Their customers are invited to attend workshops and conferences.
D Their products are usually available to buy online.

4 How has the cooperative helped its members?
A It has helped members in promoting their business.
B It has encouraged members to do their own marketing.
C It has shown members how to gain a competitive edge.
D It has taught them how to negotiate with wholesalers.

5 What does the article say about local bicycle shops?
A They are not as profitable as they used to be.
B There are far more than there were in the past.
C They are effective at increasing local business activity.
D There are several not-for-profit bicycle shops now.

/10

WRITING

5 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

did so	**do**	**nevertheless**	**owing to**	**such**	**that's**	**this**	**yet**

1 Tricia was advised to invest her money in a tech startup. She _____ and she made a fortune.
2 _____ a lack of interest, the event has been cancelled.
3 Some of the students' exams went missing. _____ what happened to my friend Jake.
4 The government has done a great deal to reduce poverty. _____, more work needs to be done.
5 Factories had been disposing of chemicals in the river. _____ resulted in the town's water supply becoming unsafe.

/5

6 Write an article with the title:

Is competition really bad for children?

Talk about the advantages and disadvantages of competition for children and express your opinion.

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /50

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Part C • Speaking

SPEAKING

1 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures.
Ask: How important is it for people to be honest in these situations?

2 Describe and compare the pictures showing people who have taken part in competitions.
How important is winning to these people?





/15

3 Answer your partner's question.

/5

Total: /20